

INTERROGATION RECORD: ASHREACH / THE WAR OF ENDLESS VIGIL / SABELLE BLACKSPIRE

Taken in a shuttered counting-room at Ashreach, in The Weeping Marshes. The lamp smoked throughout. The prisoner's hands remained upon the table. No seal of authority was shown to the recorder.

RECORDER: State your name and office.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: Sabelle Blackspire. Quartermaster.

RECORDER: You are entered as born in 341 AS?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: That is the entry.

RECORDER: Your appearance is not entered. Your temperament is not entered. Only your office is given. Do you dispute this?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: No.

RECORDER: Then let the record show that Sabelle Blackspire is a minor figure of the Ashen Era, known here by her service as a Quartermaster, with no canonical physical features or canonical temperament established.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: You dress an empty page as evidence.

RECORDER: Ashreach lies in The Weeping Marshes. It is currently contested. Its garrison numbers 2598. Is that false?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: I will not correct a figure copied by men who count spears but not graves.

RECORDER: A defended but unsettled holding, then?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: Ashreach is ash caught in water. It holds because it is held. It trembles because every hand upon it may slip.

RECORDER: You speak of atmosphere, not supply.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: Supply is atmosphere when the roads drown.

RECORDER: We turn to The War of Endless Vigil. It began in 247 AS and ended in 251 AS. The war caused 81577 casualties. Confirm these entries.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: They are the entries.

RECORDER: The war ended with the total rout of the aggressors. The Bleeding Crown is recorded as the victor.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: Recorded.

RECORDER: Yet the losing commander was bribed to withdraw.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: You say "yet" as though victory is a clean bowl. I say the bowl was passed hand to hand, and no one washed it.

RECORDER: Who paid the bribe?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: You have not placed a name before me.

RECORDER: Was payment made in stores?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: A Quartermaster knows the weight of a crate. A bribe has no honest weight.

RECORDER: Did you witness the withdrawal?

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: I witnessed what armies leave behind: blood-marked watchfulness, exhausted ranks, and a line breaking beneath prolonged vigilance. Whether that was courage or purchase belongs to those who write victory.

RECORDER: You evade.

SABELLE BLACKSPIRE: I endure questioning. Do not mistake the two.

At this point the lamp failed. The remaining answers are marked illegible. The record is retained despite lacking confession, attribution, or proof beyond the established entries.